

Family mealtimes were becoming a real struggle.

We have four kids, aged 11 to 17, and it can be hard to please everyone. They often complain about what is being served and have an entitlement attitude to family dinners—an expectation that someone will cook for them.

I told the kids things were going to change and they had to cook for us. I was worried they would fight about it and I would have to nag them.

Sure enough, when reading the recipe they did complain about the ingredients. And they were reluctant to go shopping at first—to be honest, they would rather play video games!

But in the end they enjoyed it because they were in control. And when it came time to eat, I was surprised to find they ate every last bit of the meal and actually enjoyed it. I think they appreciated the meal more because they were the ones who had cooked it. That was a real eye-opener for me!

I was surprised by how easy the whole process was—my youngest timed how long it took them to cook the meal and it was only 30 minutes. They didn't argue while shopping or cooking—they worked beautifully as a team. I'm a very proud parent.

The grandparents were so delighted to get an invitation to dinner and loved watching the kids work as a team to prepare a meal for them. The whole night was one we will all cherish and remember.

In fact, it was such a success, we're going to do it on a regular basis. I'm going to start a roster and teach them a handful of recipes so they're prepared for when they leave home!